Launch Control XL 3 — Template (one controller) — ambient · techno · house

Basis for all three tracks. Every row means the same on both controllers and in every track: row 1 = brightness, row 2 = space, row 3 = character (calm ↔ lively), fader = how much of it, button 1 = change, button 2 = a moment, right now.

Jojo plays the foundation (beat and bass) on all 8 columns. Jonas plays the colour (chords and melodies) on columns 1–7; Jonas' column 8 controls everything: both controllers and the Launchkey.

Examples per column: A = ambient, T = groove techno, H = happy house. Every track starts with all faders down, and with all knobs at 0 it must already sound good.

One controller: Mode 1 = Jojo (foundation, columns 1–7; Jojo's column 8 (Shaker / Ride) stays off; Mode 1 sends the same CCs as Mode 16), Mode 2 = Jonas (colour). Column 8 is global on both pages.

Knob | Fader | Button | global (all modes) | unused

Mode 1 — Jojo: Foundation (beat + bass) · same CCs as Mode 16

	1 Pulse / Kick	2 Rumble / Noise	3 Sub	4 Bassline	5 Backbeat	6 Hats	7 Percussion	8 Global
Row 1 Brightness	CC 13 **Brightness** dull thump ↔ clicky attack. Never fully closed.	CC 14 **Brightness** deep rumble ↔ airy hiss.	CC 15 **Brightness** pure sine ↔ a little buzz on top.	CC 16 **Brightness** round and dark ↔ buzzing, squelchy.	CC 17 **Brightness** soft and far ↔ sharp crack.	CC 18 **Brightness** soft hiss ↔ crisp and sharp.	CC 19 **Brightness** woody ↔ metallic.	CC 20 **Fog** all devices. 0 = clear, up = everything gets darker, as if under water.
Row 2 Space	CC 21 **Space** dry and close ↔ far away in a big room (reverb + echo).	CC 22 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 23 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 24 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 25 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 26 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 27 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 28 **Room** all devices. 0 = each sound's own room, up = everything drowns in reverb.
Row 3 Character	CC 29 **Softness** 0 = soft and round (the default) ↔ a deep, soft thump. Punch comes from row 1 (click).	CC 30 **Motion** still ↔ rolling waves / sweeps.	CC 31 **Length** long held tones ↔ short blips.	CC 32 **Groove** few notes ↔ busy, bouncing line.	CC 33 **Ghost notes** 0 = plain backbeat ↔ extra quiet hits in between.	CC 34 **Density** the pattern as it is ↔ + quiet 16ths ↔ + little rolls.	CC 35 **Density** steady pattern ↔ + ghost notes and rolls.	CC 36 **Tension** build-up for all devices: filters open, echo grows, rolls tighten. Back to 0 = release.
Fader Level	CC 5 **Level** 0 = gone. Tuned to the key. A: heartbeat thump · T: kick · H: four-on-the-floor kick.	CC 6 **Level** A: sea and wind · T: rumble on the 3rd + 4th 16th, same pitch as the kick · H: noise sweeps.	CC 7 **Level** A: deep drone sub · T: pumping sub between the kicks · H: sub under the bassline.	CC 8 **Level** A: slow bass swells · T: raw off-beat bass · H: bouncy bassline.	CC 9 **Level** A: soft rim click · T: clap on 2 and 4 · H: clap + snare.	CC 10 **Level** A: clock ticks · T: 16th hats · H: off-beat open hat.	CC 11 **Level** A: wood clicks, drops · T: tuned bongos, rimshot · H: congas, bongos.	CC 12 **Master Level** volume of everything: both controllers and the Launchkey.
Button 1 Change	CC 37 **Change** next of at most 3 patterns, at the next bar.	CC 38 **Change** next of at most 3 patterns.	CC 39 **Change** next of at most 3 patterns.	CC 40 **Change** next of at most 3 patterns.	CC 41 **Change** next of at most 3 patterns.	CC 42 **Change** next of at most 3 patterns.	CC 43 **Change** next of at most 3 patterns.	CC 44 **Chapter** next mood / chords for all, next phrase.
Button 2 Moment	CC 45 **Drop out** kick pauses while held.	CC 46 **Riser** noise rises while held.	CC 47 **Slide** notes glide into each other while held.	CC 48 **Octave** one octave up while held.	CC 49 **Roll** snare roll while held.	CC 50 **Open** hats ring long while held.	CC 51 **Fill** a fill while held.	CC 52 **Break / Drop** 1st: beat out. 2nd: all back on the one.

Mode 2 — Jonas: Colour (chords + melodies) · CC + 48

	1 Pad	2 Chords	3 Arp	4 Lead	5 Answer	6 Sparkle	7 FX / Risers	8 Global (all devices)
Row 1 Brightness	CC 61 **Brightness** muffled ↔ open and airy.	CC 62 **Brightness** warm ↔ bright, glassy.	CC 63 **Brightness** soft plucks ↔ sharp, sparkling.	CC 64 **Brightness** soft and round ↔ biting (acid squelch).	CC 65 **Brightness** hushed ↔ clear.	CC 66 **Brightness** soft glow ↔ glittering.	CC 67 **Brightness** dark whoosh ↔ bright shimmer.	CC 20 **Fog** all devices. 0 = clear, up = everything gets darker, as if under water.
Row 2 Space	CC 69 **Space** dry and close ↔ far away in a big room (reverb + echo).	CC 70 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 71 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 72 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 73 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 74 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 75 **Space** dry ↔ far away.	CC 28 **Room** all devices. 0 = each sound's own room, up = everything drowns in reverb.
Row 3 Character	CC 77 **Swell** still ↔ slowly breathing in and out.	CC 78 **Rhythm** long held chords ↔ short, choppy stabs.	CC 79 **Range** few slow notes ↔ fast and wide.	CC 80 **Glide** plain notes ↔ notes slide into each other.	CC 81 **Voices** one voice ↔ two-, three-part harmony.	CC 82 **Density** a sparkle now and then ↔ a rain of notes.	CC 83 **Amount** subtle ↔ wild.	CC 36 **Tension** build-up for all devices: filters open, echo grows, rolls tighten. Back to 0 = release.
Fader Level	CC 53 **Level** 0 = gone. A: long floating chords · T: dark pad · H: warm strings.	CC 54 **Level** A: soft chord swells · T: dub chord stabs · H: piano chords.	CC 55 **Level** A: slow music box · T: hypnotic sequence · H: bright arp.	CC 56 **Level** A: choir or whale calls · T: acid line · H: vocal hook / lead.	CC 57 **Level** A: second choir voice · T: counter blips · H: melody that answers the lead.	CC 58 **Level** A: glitter drops · T: metallic pings · H: bells, plucks.	CC 59 **Level** A: shimmer swells · T: slowly breathing noise · H: risers, vocal chops.	CC 12 **Master Level** volume of everything: both controllers and the Launchkey.
Button 1 Change	CC 85 **Change** next pattern / melody, at the next bar.	CC 86 **Change** next pattern / melody.	CC 87 **Change** next pattern / melody.	CC 88 **Change** next pattern / melody.	CC 89 **Change** next pattern / melody.	CC 90 **Change** next pattern / melody.	CC 91 **Change** next pattern / melody.	CC 44 **Chapter** next mood / chords for all, next phrase.
Button 2 Moment	CC 93 **Freeze** holds the current chord while held.	CC 94 **Stab** one accent chord, now.	CC 95 **Octave** one octave up while held.	CC 96 **Echo throw** the last note echoes away.	CC 97 **Answer** plays one phrase, now.	CC 98 **Burst** one quick run of sparkles.	CC 99 **Hit** one FX hit / impact.	CC 52 **Break / Drop** 1st: beat out. 2nd: all back on the one.

Guide

One language, three tracks

The rows never change their meaning: row 1 = brightness, row 2 = space, row 3 = character, fader = how much, button 1 = change, button 2 = a moment. Whoever learned it in the ambient track can play techno and house without a new explanation.

The columns keep their role: Jojo's column 1 is always the heartbeat (a soft thump in ambient, the kick in techno and house) and column 2 the noise or rumble glued to it; Jonas' column 4 is always the main melody. The sound behind it changes, the job stays.

Left = low and long, right = high and short, on both controllers.

Two players

Jojo is the foundation: beat and bass, the floor everybody stands on. Jonas is the colour: chords and melodies on top, plus the global column 8, which acts on everything (both controllers and the Launchkey).

Jojo has no global column on purpose: the global hand is one person, so there is never a fight about master level, tension or the drop.

Learning path

In ambient: faders, brightness and space only. Slow, forgiving, nothing can go wrong. Buttons hardly matter yet.

In techno: the same controls, plus time. Button 1 (change) and button 2 (moments), row 3 for groove and density.

In house: plus harmony and drama. Chapter changes the chords, Tension and Break / Drop shape build-ups. Now the two players have to agree: Jojo drops the beat, Jonas brings it back.

Rules for every track

Every position sounds good: ranges are limited, no fader is too loud, no filter goes silent, melodies stay in key.

All knobs at 0 is the default sound and must already sound good: soft kick, plain backbeat, steady percussion, warm colour. Turning up adds, it does not repair.

Jojo's button 1 has at most 3 patterns per column: the foundation should be easy to steer. Jonas may have more.

Kick, rumble, sub and bass are tuned to the key of the track, so the low end sounds like one instrument.

Sound: raw and warm rather than glossy (no EDM sheen): a little drive, noise and detune, gentle glides (at most a semitone), echoes and room instead of bright synth leads.

Every control is clearly audible. A control nobody can hear is left grey (unused) rather than mapped.

Start with all faders down and build the track up together. That way the controller and the code agree from the first second.

A track may leave columns empty or swap an example, but never move a role to another column or a meaning to another row.

Launchkey 25 MK4 (open)

Still to be decided: what the Launchkey plays (keys for melody, pads for drums, …). Fixed already: Jonas' column 8 controls it too. Master level, Fog, Room and Tension act on its sound, Chapter changes its key and chords, Break / Drop includes it.

Playing alone

A run is: build the beat in Mode 1, switch to Mode 2, add colour, use column 8 for the drop. Mode 1 is set up in Components with the same CCs as Mode 16.

Faders are shared hardware: after a mode switch each sound keeps its value until you touch its fader, then it jumps to where the fader physically is. Move faders gently after switching.